EU Arctic Strategy pairs security push with green pledges

送信者: POLITICO Pro Alert 受信日時: 2026-10-19 22:57

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By Martina Sapio, Gerardo Fortuna · Oct 19, 2026, 3:56 PM · View in your browser

BRUSSELS — The European Union wants to monitor security in the Arctic while also ensuring access to critical raw materials and energy, according to a draft Arctic Strategy communication seen by POLITICO.

The strategy is due to be released Tuesday and updates the EU's 2021 Arctic policy . It aims to prepare for rising military and commercial activity as melting ice opens new routes and resource opportunities in the north.

The strategy was first reported by Bloomberg.

A proposed maritime hub would combine national and EU data to track shadow fleet vessels, monitor infrastructure, detect illegal fishing and pollution, and support search and rescue and navigation safety. Member countries would lead the effort and it would be designed to complement NATO.

A dedicated Arctic Cable Hub would monitor, protect and help repair submarine cables in the North Atlantic and Arctic.

On defense and transport, the draft backs Arctic-ready dual-use capabilities and upgraded transport corridors that can support military mobility. It calls for faster implementation of the Rail Nordica project in northern Finland and expanded icebreaker capabilities.

The EU would also study the implications of emerging Arctic shipping routes and promote compliance with international rules.

The strategy promises to develop renewable energy in the Arctic but reaffirms the EU's commitment not to drill for oil and gas. It also says the bloc will continue working with Canada, Greenland, Norway and the United States to develop critical raw materials.

The document includes non-binding commitments on climate change, biodiversity loss and sustainable fishing. It also promises to launch an "initiative to promote local public and private investment in the Arctic around blue economy sectors."

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